

HISTORY OF THE

SAN DIEGO

PSYCHOANALYTIC CENTER

*A Half-Century of Clinical, Academic,
and Community Leadership*

1960 — 2026

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Our story begins with a collection of vibrant, clashing, and deeply committed personalities held together by a shared professional goal.

If you were to walk into a room of San Diego analysts today, you would find a blend of rigorous professional integrity and a warm, approachable culture that has been our constant through decades of growth.

This narrative is a journey through that history, celebrating the architects, philanthropists, and mentors who transformed a local study group into a pillar of the national psychoanalytic community.

The Founding Fathers: 1960–1969

The seeds for a psychoanalytic institute were planted one day in the early 1960s in the living room of Allan Rosenblatt. He was having coffee with his best friend Jim Thickstun. At the time, of the 30 psychiatrists then in San Diego they were the only psychoanalysts, having come to San Diego in the 1950s. They were already involved in starting a psychoanalytic study group in San Diego. But on this day, they realized that their real goal was to have a psychoanalytic institute in San Diego.

The study group was eventually expanded by the arrival of other analysts who came to San Diego, including Vince Mazzanti, Dick Hicks, Felix Loeb, Sandy Izner, and Ada and Art Burris. It also included a jeweler, Manny Lippett, who had moved from Los Angeles to San Diego in 1960. He brought with him his long-time interest and financial support for psychoanalysis and was invited to join the study group.

But the two visionaries, Rosenblatt and Thickstun, knew that for the American Psychoanalytic Association to grant them a provisional and ultimately fully accredited psychoanalytic institute in San Diego, they needed senior training analysts with national standing. This led to a critical recruitment mission that brought two training analysts, Douglas Orr from Seattle and Saul Karlen from New York, to San Diego.

Douglas Orr, the more senior founding training analyst, was essential to creating institutional value in the eyes of the national organization. There was an English scholarly quality, as well as a shyness about him. He was at times a man of few words, but when he spoke everyone listened. His intellectual interests and love of reading contributed to his awareness that a psychoanalytic institute needed a library. Thus, it was that he and his wife, Jean, catalyzed the creation of our first library, ensuring we were a center of scholarship from the very beginning.

Saul Karlen had a suave and elegant quality and even a look about him that reminded some of us of the actor Adolphe Menjou. He was a man of wisdom and a droll sense of humor. He provided the academic foundation along with heretical whispers of wisdom that favored clinical flexibility. He once famously whispered to an early student, Eli Miller, “Eli, I have to tell you that despite all we say, a twice-a-week psychoanalytic psychotherapy can sometimes be as good as a four-times-a-week psychoanalysis”.

The San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute is Born: 1970

And it all worked. In 1970, the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute (SDPI) was born and became a reality, under the umbrella of the Los Angeles Psychoanalytic Institute and what was called the Joint Committee. At the same time, the study group transformed into the San Diego Psychoanalytic Society (SDPS). They both operated in rented office space in the El Patio building in La Jolla, where Arden King served as our dedicated first executive secretary, her salary generously paid by Sandy Izner.

When the first classes began in 1970, all the psychoanalysts in the study group became members of the faculty of the new San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute. The primary figures were the two training analysts, Douglas Orr and Saul Karlen, along with Allan Rosenblatt, Jim Thickstun, Sandy Izner, and Dick Hicks. The four of them soon achieved training analyst status after going through evaluations by the Los Angeles Psychoanalytic Institute.

These were the main characters in the drama of the early years of the Institute, as we usually referred to it. They were a motley group of unique and strong personalities who often worked well and creatively together in the best interests of the Institute. They were also at times in conflict with each other related to particular issues. Sometimes it had more to do with their different personalities which created some drama that was often entertaining to watch.

Allan Rosenblatt was known for his high intellect and precocity (he graduated from high school at the age of 16 and medical school at 22) as well as his fundamental optimism. He would often kid colleagues out of pessimistic funks by saying, “look for the pony in the room. If the room is full of manure, there’s bound to be a pony somewhere”. He believed that if you worked at it together, things would work out for the best. Some suspected that what he really meant was if you had enough meetings together.

This optimism was coupled with a penchant for accuracy. It was joked, but true, that he never met the minutes of a meeting that he didn’t have a list of corrections for. In this he had both a purity of intent and a bit of naïveté. He actually thought that if someone made an incorrect statement they would, of course, want to be corrected, even publicly. This did not extend to

differences of opinion or ideas, which Allan was always open to.

And among the early training analysts, he was the first liberal, the first to advocate for greater democratization in our educational governance. It was said about him that no one gave more in time, energy, teaching, and leadership to the life and work of our analytic community. He was a member of every committee, chaired every committee, taught every course, and held every office and administrative position, including chair of the board and twice director of education.

Jim Thickstun, who served one term as director of education, was our first power weightlifter. He really was. He also worked out as a boxer and his physique showed it. This was consistent with the workmanlike quality to his teaching and supervision. For the most part he was a gentle soul. But he could become testy, even enraged, if he felt he was being crossed or not respected, even by a good friend.

Once at an Education Committee meeting, Allan Rosenblatt was about to make his fifth correction of Jim's minutes of the last meeting, at which point Jim slammed the minutes down onto the table and shouted, "Allan, you've had your four corrections. That's enough!"

Once while attending American Psychoanalytic meetings at the Waldorf Hotel in New York, he and his wife were mugged while returning late from dinner with friends. At which point Jim gave chase to catch the robbers who had run off with his wife's purse and his billfold, while yelling, "Stop, you thieves!" He finally gave up after three blocks, and out of breath trudged back to where his wife and the others were awaiting him, petrified at what he had done. His analytic colleagues were frightened for him but mostly horrified that his behavior would tarnish his image as a training analyst as well as that of the American Psychoanalytic Association as a thoughtful and reflective organization.

Dick Hicks was the youngest of the four San Diego analysts who became training analysts, having obtained his psychoanalytic training in the 1960s by traveling to Los Angeles. He was also the most free-thinking and was a bit of a young Turk. He once began a class on dreams by saying, "none of these assigned articles are really worth reading, but let's discuss them and see what we can come up with".

He was also known to have the messiest office. To many students, he was the most popular teacher. Some of this was his style of talking to students as respected peers. But it was also related to his being the only instructor who, as part of his teaching, shared some of his own psychoanalytic patient process notes of sessions. He was attuned to the students and their needs and was very attentive and supportive of them. To his disappointment, he was never asked to be Director of Education. The other training analysts, while respecting his clinical and teaching skills, did not trust his organizational skills. This was a disappointment to many, some of whom suggested, only partly in jest, that his messy office came back to haunt him. Despite his disappointment, he never

stopped being a good man with a good heart and an open and curious mind.

Sandy Izner moved to San Diego from Detroit in 1968 after vacationing here and becoming aware of the study group and plans for a psychoanalytic institute. He had a genuine and considerable innate insight regarding psychodynamics, character, and individuals. He was an interpersonal power. So, it was no surprise that although a latecomer to San Diego, he was quickly turned to as a leader. He was asked to be the first director of education of the new San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute, as well as chair of the Joint Committee.

With his larger-than-life personality and political savvy, he was seen as the right man to navigate us through the hurdles placed by the Los Angeles Psychoanalytic Institute and the American Psychoanalytic Association to achieve independent status as a fully accredited psychoanalytic institute. And this he did with relish and political skill. We were granted full accreditation from the Board on Professional Standards of the American Psychoanalytic Association in 1977, sooner than had been expected.

At this point Sandy expressed a wish to continue to be director of education for an indefinite period of time. This led to conflict and resistance from the other training analysts, particularly Allan Rosenblatt and Jim Thickstun. They instead introduced a rotating model which was approved by the Education Committee, in which directors would be elected for a set term. Following this, Sandy's relationship with the other early training analysts was never quite the same.

But among most of the membership and students, he remained a beloved figure. Many enjoyed the frequent sight of him slowly cruising down Prospect Street in his iconic, extremely long red Cadillac El Dorado convertible, sometimes shirtless if he was returning to his office from a volleyball game at the beach. His humor was sometimes a bit off-color but not offensive. At least not for the times. It was Sandy. He was forgiven much because of his charm, generosity, and personality. He was everyone's uncle.

Manny Lippett: First Chair of the Board and the Philanthropic Soul

At the same time that the founding San Diego analysts turned to Sandy Izner to be the first Director of Education for the new San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute, they turned to Manny Lippett to be the first Chair of the Board, making the two of them our first leadership duo. They both served in those positions from 1970 to 1978. Even though they had met only two years before when Izner came to San Diego, they had already become close, recognizing in each other a deep dedication to psychoanalysis and the fledgling San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute. For the rest of their lives, they remained the closest of friends. Every morning Sandy would telephone Manny and

the two of them would ponder the questions of the day, including those related to the Institute.

Manny's life read like a Horatio Alger success story of a poor immigrant boy who with hard work and self-education found great success in America. His life began in 1906 in a small village in the Ukraine in Czarist Russia. To get away from the anti-Semitism and the Czarist pogroms, Manny's family, including his six brothers and sisters, came to America when Manny was seven years old and settled on the Lower East Side of New York. His father opened a small and not very successful restaurant, and by the time Manny was 14 years old he was the primary provider for his family, working and learning in the jewelry business.

Having to drop out of school, he continued his education the only way he could, by going to night school and checking out multiple books from the library which he voraciously read late into the night. At the age of 18 he formed his own jewelry manufacturing company. He already was a member of the Young People's Socialist League. He gave rousing socialist speeches in the streets and parks of New York. He was once actually arrested while speaking at a rally for Emma Goldman, the famous radical feminist.

Fortunately for him and us, at the age of 20 his interests turned to psychoanalysis and he began to devour the writings of Freud and other psychoanalysts. He idealistically saw psychoanalysis, as did many psychoanalysts of the time, as having the potential to cure not only the problems of individuals but also the ills of society.

In 1936, Manny moved with his multiple jewelry stores to Los Angeles where he obtained his own personal analysis and became involved in the local psychoanalytic community. And, ultimately as he later would do in San Diego, he became one of the founders of the Los Angeles Psychoanalytic Institute, as well as a member of their board and a financial benefactor.

It was our good fortune that in 1960 Manny moved with his family and jewelry stores to San Diego and played essentially the same, but more intimate role in San Diego, that he did in Los Angeles. He became our primary philanthropic pillar. As chairman of our board, with his humor and tact he was a master mediator, often smoothing the dramas sometimes created by the clashing personalities of the founding analysts. He forever remained to us "Chairman of the Board". And if Sandy Izner was everyone's uncle, Manny was everyone's grandfather.

First Classes and First Students: 1970s

The start of classes in 1970 was an exciting time for the instructors and the students (candidates as they were called then). In their enthusiasm about having a psychoanalytic institute, individual faculty members often showed up and attended classes they were not even assigned to teach. And

for the students, there was the excitement of knowing they were a part of history.

The first students in the new SDPI were, like the first analysts, themselves a group of diverse personalities and backgrounds. In the 1970 class were Harry Woods, Burt Conn, Morrie Oscherwitz, and Haig Koshkarian. In the class beginning in 1971 were Alvin Robbins and Gary Shepherd. All (except Harry Woods) had come to San Diego, as Haig put it, “at the invitation of Uncle Sam”. It was the Vietnam War years and the then doctor draft brought all of them to San Diego to serve as psychiatrists for two years at naval bases in San Diego. Becoming aware of the plans for the fledgling analytic institute in San Diego, they all applied and were accepted and remained in San Diego.

Harry Woods was about ten years older than the others in that first class because of his circuitous and fascinating journey to San Diego. After graduating from high school during World War II, he enlisted in the Navy. He was on a battleship in the Pacific when the dropping of the first atom bomb on Japan was announced over the ship loudspeaker. After his discharge from the Navy, he went to college on the GI Bill and became a chemistry teacher for several years. He then decided to go to medical school and then become a psychiatrist and then a psychoanalyst, which brought him to San Diego. His history and droll sense of humor made him a most interesting and lovable classmate.

Morris Oscherwitz from Cincinnati, an excellent student, looked like Walter Matthau and sometimes talked and acted like him. He was the only one who after graduating returned to his previous home.

Burt Conn was a serious and good student with a bit of a bon vivant quality about him. He would come to Institute events with his latest attractive girlfriend, once even a Tahitian princess, hoping his classmates would take note and feel envious. They all pretended not to notice.

Haig Koshkarian already showed some of his satiric sense of humor as well as his interest in history (in his first year of medical school he cut classes to read Winston Churchill’s six-volume “History of World War II”, as well as “The Rise and Fall of the Third Reich” by William Shirer) that portended the later place he would take as the Institute’s satiric entertainer and keeper of our history.

Gary Shepherd, in the second class, was an affable fellow who at times felt outshined and a bit overwhelmed by his classmate Alvin Robbins, who was very bright with a tongue-in-cheek sense of humor and a competitive spirit. He dominated the class discussions, but Gary always remained in good spirits. However, he was known at times to have had enough and need a break and would call in sick for class, leaving the floor entirely to Alvin.

Not surprisingly, among the first and second Institute classes, Alvin was the first to graduate, becoming the first graduate of the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute. Haig was the second to graduate, which he later used as part of a comic bit in which he went on and on protesting too much that it did not bother him at all that Alvin graduated first and he graduated second, finally ending with “I’m just going to say one more thing and nothing more... and that is that I could have graduated first if I wanted to. But that just wasn’t important to me”.

As was the case throughout our history, most of the graduates who remained in San Diego took their place in the life and work of the Institute, including teaching as a member of the faculty, sitting on committees, and sometimes taking on leadership positions. In effect finding their own niche. Al Robbins was the first graduate to become a training analyst. Both he and Haig Koshkarian took on leadership positions. After serving as president and chair of the board, Alvin served two terms in the 1990s as the director of education. During this same time in the 1990s, Haig served two terms as president and chair of the board. It seemed fitting to some that both of them held those major leadership positions at the same time.

With his common sense and sense of humor, Haig came to be seen, throughout our evolution and history of growth pains and gains, as a dependable source for integrity, perspective, and wisdom. But it was always suspected that his greatest pleasure was his niche as the Institute’s designated entertainer and satirist. Beginning in the 1980s, he became the M.C. at formal dinners at which outgoing officers were thanked and honored, as well as roasted. He then began also to write comedy radio shows which he performed with other members (which came to be called the SDPC Players) at Institute holiday parties and other gatherings. Things and people psychoanalytic and the Institute itself were satirized. It was seen as important to be able to laugh at ourselves, something not always found in psychoanalytic institutes.

At times Haig used humor not merely to satirize himself or others, but to satirize a policy decision he disagreed with. This led to what has been called his “Red Wine Letter”. When the Board was seriously considering a ban on red wines at SDPC Holiday Parties out of concern about red wine carpet stains, Haig decided to take a stand. He wrote a formal letter of protest to the Board accusing them of discrimination (wines of color vs. white) and being unpatriotic (Red, White, and Blue). He ended by noting that the faded red wine stain on his own living room carpet only added character to it, as well as fond memories. It remains unknown how much Haig’s letter contributed to the Board ultimately deciding against such a ban.

Two other early graduates, Davis Suskind and Eli Miller, became two of the best examples of graduates who, for their own reasons did not wish to be training analysts, but loved to teach at the Institute and were excellent at it. Davis in addition was a most popular teacher at the UCSD Department of Psychiatry where he taught a long-running and very popular course on

psychoanalytic topics to the psychiatry residents. In fact, it was recently resumed, with the residents coming to SDPC for the classes. Eli, in addition to his teaching, to which he brought a lively and warm sense of humor, was instrumental in our gradual move to a more inclusive and democratic form of educational governance.

Dan Gardner, another early graduate, is a good example of someone who in addition to teaching and sitting on committees, made his own niche based on his particular interests. For Dan it often has been taking note of what seemed to him to be needed in the psychoanalytic community at a particular time. This has included suggesting and then organizing a dinner to honor Cal Colarusso, who in spite of his many years of accomplishments and service to SDPC had never received such an evening, because he had never served as Chair of the Board or Director of Education. Also, Dan's "In the Spotlight Series" for the SDPC website, in which graduates recount their experience and benefits of psychoanalytic training, and his promoting as a member of the Executive Committee of the Board a welcoming institutional cultural and community outreach. And of course, his birthing of this very podcast and narrative about our history, including collecting and organizing the voluminous materials involved.

New Arrivals

In 1971, Bob Nemiroff, a fully trained psychoanalyst, arrived from New Haven. Bob was already known as a tremendously talented teacher, and the UCSD Department of Psychiatry soon had the good sense to immediately hire him as director of their psychiatry residency training program. It was a decision that had an immensely positive, decades-long impact on both the UCSD psychiatry residency program and our analytic training program.

Then in 1973, Cal Colarusso, a newly trained adult and child psychoanalyst, arrived from Pennsylvania. He was San Diego's first child psychoanalyst, and soon child development was added to the curriculum and Cal began teaching it. He became the primary architect of our fledgling child analytic training program.

Bob and Cal soon became office mates and began collaborating in writing articles and then a book, "Adult Development: A New Dimension in Psychodynamic Theory and Development".

Later, Cal was instrumental in adding an international component to our training program by establishing a connection with psychiatrists from South Korea who then came to San Diego for analytic training. Over the years their numbers reached close to 25 and some thought of them as our farm team.

Many thought Cal at some point would take his turn at becoming the Institute's Director of Education. But after being caught in the crossfire between Sandy Izner and Jim Thickstun when Jim was Director of Education, he lost any interest in such an office. Instead, he focused on what had always been his greatest interest and passion, teaching and writing. He taught both at the Institute and at UCSD, where he became the Director of the Child Psychiatry Training program.

And he continued to write articles for professional journals, numbering well over 50, as well as eight professional books and ten audiobooks on Amazon. Cal brought an amazing enthusiasm and optimism to whatever he did. It was said that he never met an adult developmental stage that he did not think was the best time in his life. Until he entered the next one and that one became the best ever.

In Bob Nemiroff's position as director of the UCSD psychiatry residency program, he brought a psychoanalytic presence to a training program which otherwise had a strong biological emphasis. He established a close relationship between the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute and the UCSD Department of Psychiatry in which his mentorship influenced a generation of psychiatrists to seek psychoanalytic training. At the same time, he enlisted many psychoanalysts and analytic trainees to teach and supervise his residents. Two of his trademark expressions with both his psychiatric residents and psychoanalytic candidates were "nothing is etched in stone" and "let's see how we can reframe this".

In 1995, Bob announced his retirement after 24 years as the first Director of the UCSD Psychiatry residency training program and looked forward to focusing on his private practice of psychotherapy and psychoanalysis, as well as continuing to teach at the San Diego Psychoanalytic institute. Many at the Institute were disappointed that with his busy and crowded professional life, he never had the time to take on in the Institute the position of Director of Education. And bring to it his ability to bring people of different perspectives together while moving forward in a way that was best for everyone.

The next new arrivals were Robert and Phyllis Tyson, who returned to this country and moved to San Diego in 1977 after several years at the Hampstead Clinic in London. Robert was already an adult and child psychoanalyst, which further added to our child psychoanalytic program. He soon became a training analyst here. Phyllis was a social worker who had worked with children at the Hampstead Clinic. In San Diego she was kept busy for the next several years completing both psychoanalytic training, as well as work for a PhD in psychology.

In their ensuing years in San Diego, in addition to teaching any and all courses they were asked to teach, they developed a national and international reputation for their writings. Some thought Robert at times had a bit of a Machiavellian way about him. But he also had a puckish, mischievous sense of humor and could laugh at himself. One of his stratagems, which he

sometimes employed at Education Committee meetings or in private conversations, was to put his words in the mouth of someone he was having a debate with about some Institute matter.

After some back and forth he would say, “perhaps what you are saying (or mean) is...” and then he would say something that was more like what he had been saying than what his “opponent” had been saying. All as a way of gaining seeming agreement with what he, himself, had been saying. He was never quite as subtle as he thought he was, and only on rare occasions did it work. Usually, it led to a shared laugh and, if it were a private conversation, another glass of wine.

To many, one of Robert’s greatest contributions later in the 1980s and into the 1990s was to make the training analyst application process more open, supportive, and friendly. Prior to this, in the 1970s and into the 1980s, future TAs were often effectively “tapped”. That is, current TAs would let certain newcomers and graduates know that they were seen as future TAs and were encouraged to apply. Most that received this message did so, presented clinical material to a “listening committee” and were accepted. Some turned down the invitation stating that, as much as they valued their training, a training analyst was not what they wanted to be. Others who might have wished to be training analysts but did not receive this “invitation” often never applied out of fear they would be turned down.

Robert began to change all of this by starting and leading a case presentation seminar for anyone who was considering applying for training analyst status. With these seminars they were able to present some of their psychoanalytic work and have it commented on, better assess their interest, as well as identify areas that might need further supervision before formally applying.

Democratization, Inclusion, and Merger: 1980s

Beginning in the first years of the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute and continuing to the present, the Director of Education was the principal educational officer and the Education Committee was that body that was responsible for the operation of the psychoanalytic training program. Initially it was made up only of training analysts, all of whom were required to be on the Education Committee. Shortly after their arrival in San Diego, and before they became training analysts themselves, Cal Colarusso and Bob Nemiroff were asked to be on the Education Committee as “faculty reps”. Actually, non-TA faculty reps. They were not allowed to vote and had to leave the room when candidates were being discussed.

In the early 1980s, to give non-TA faculty a sense of involvement, the office of chair of the faculty (really chair of the non-TA faculty) was created by Allan Rosenblatt, Director of Education at the time, and assigned to Eli Miller, a recent graduate. The office was never a formal part of our

governance, and Allan did not really know what would become of it. But Eli took the post and ran with it. He brought to the position a history of being a bit of a long-haired social and political activist in college. He no longer had his long hair but his activist instincts were still alive, and he turned the office into a position of leadership and importance.

He began having faculty meetings (for non-TA faculty) where issues important to them were discussed and brought by him to the Education Committee. Eventually a certain number of non-TA faculty members were voted on at these meetings and became non-voting members of the Education Committee. At some point some training analysts, feeling left out, began coming to Eli's meetings. Allan Rosenblatt was the first training analyst to say, "hey, I'm a member of the faculty too".

Eli's leadership and the discussions at these meetings ultimately led to a formal faculty vote and a subsequent bylaw change bringing the process and makeup of the Education Committee to what it now is. Training analysts were no longer placed on the Education Committee simply by virtue of being a TA. Instead, all faculty, TA and non-TA alike, were nominated and voted on by the entire faculty. And those elected became full voting members of the Education Committee.

Some faculty, while applauding this democratization of our educational governance, were disappointed that it did not more quickly bring with it a greater presence in the curriculum of some of the newer literature on psychoanalytic theory and technique. Nor did it immediately lead to a relaxing of what some viewed as too rigid requirements for admission, progression, and graduation in the analytic training program, as well as becoming a training analyst. All of this was to come later, beginning in the 1990s (when Eli became chair of the entire faculty) and then accelerated in the decades to come.

The 1980s also saw the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute become more inclusive as it opened its doors to non-MD applicants for psychoanalytic training. This was against the American Psychoanalytic Association's long-standing dictum that only physician psychiatrists could be admitted for psychoanalytic training at member institutes. This draconian rule stood in stark contrast to Sigmund Freud's own vision that psychoanalytic training should be open to all professions, which became the model in European institutes.

In 1985, the American Psychological Association filed a class-action antitrust suit on behalf of four clinical psychologists against the American Psychoanalytic Association, arguing that the training restrictions on non-MD mental health clinicians was illegal. It was settled out of court in 1988 and implemented in 1989 with the American Psychoanalytic Association's declaration that member institutes now had to admit qualified non-physicians (they were not happy about it). The long-standing medical monopoly on psychoanalytic training was over.

But the San Diego Psychoanalytic Institute had already been ahead of its time. In the early 1980s, well before the American Psychological Association suit and settlement, SDPI was one of the few psychoanalytic institutes that was already helping non-MD mental health professionals receive full psychoanalytic training at SDPI by obtaining a waiver from the American Psychoanalytic Association based on the applicant's assertion that they sought psychoanalytic training only for research or scholarly purposes. We felt that the American Psychoanalytic Association's inappropriate stance warranted such a deceit.

And so it was that beginning in the early 1980's, we welcomed and admitted for psychoanalytic training three PhD clinical psychologists, Joanne Callan, Steve Silk and Alan Sugarman; a clinical social worker Phyllis Tyson; a PhD professor of history Judith Hughes; a dentist Nadine Levinson whose relentless determination was essential, as it took well over a year for her to obtain her waiver; and an engineer, Benoit Vincent, who will become the Chair of the Board in July, 2027. All of them went on to take and continue to take very important places in our history. This pluralism continues to be celebrated as a very important part of our analytic community. And in fact, it is a continuing and growing hallmark of it.

The decade culminated in the pivotal 1989 merger of the Society (the collegial and continuing education wing) and the Institute (the academic training program wing) into the San Diego Psychoanalytic Society and Institute. There had been much administrative, financial, and leadership overlap and redundancy. The income from Society membership dues was much greater than the Institute income from tuition. To compensate for this, the Society often paid inflated rent to the Institute to use their space for their members' meetings and scientific meetings.

At a dinner meeting to celebrate the merger, M.C. Haig Koshkarian dryly suggested that the Institute did not merge with the Society. Rather, it ate the Society to get its money. There was in fact some reality to this. But as Haig added, it made good sense to combine the two organizations' activities, finances, and officers into one organization. Too many people had been wearing two hats and it was more efficient to become one organization.

The Psychoanalytic Psychotherapy Program: 1983 to the Present

In 1983, just 13 years after its first psychoanalytic class, the San Diego Psychoanalytic Society and Institute began its first Psychoanalytic Psychotherapy Program (PPP) class. It was the second of its kind, the first being that of the Boston Psychoanalytic Institute. To keep it out of the eyesight of the American Psychoanalytic Association, it was made part of the Extension Division.

The PPP was the brainchild of Alvin Robbins, its first director. But also, that of others such as Bob Nemiroff, Allan Rosenblatt, and Davis Suskind. Davis and Allan in particular spent countless

hours conceptualizing what such a program and its curriculum would be. The main idea was to give non-MD mental health professionals, who could not get analytic training without going through the uncertain rigors of seeking a waiver from the American Psychoanalytic Association, a program where they could learn about psychoanalytic theory, ideas, and technique and their place in psychoanalytically informed psychotherapy. It was also based on the conviction that psychoanalytically informed psychotherapy could stand on its own as a respected, effective, and important psychotherapy.

In fact, it was about at this same time that it became apparent that many of our Analytic Program graduates and students, even some in the very first classes, had come for psychoanalytic training not so much with the goal of having a traditional psychoanalytic practice. But they came more with the goal of becoming the best psychoanalytically informed psychotherapists that they could be.

Not surprisingly, our new Psychoanalytic Psychotherapy Program was an immediate success. And has remained so to the present time. Many of the graduates have remained part of the analytic community, including teaching in the PPP. Even after analytic training became open to non-MD mental health professionals in the late 1980s, many of them continued to apply to the PPP, as did some MD psychiatrists.

In the mid-1990s, Steve Silk, who was director of the PPP at the time, suggested that the PPP, as one of our major training programs, deserved the respect and place of reporting to the Education Committee rather than being part of the Extension Division. This was unanimously affirmed in a bylaw change.

The next director of the PPP, Joanne Callan, gave the PPP Executive Committee, made up of PPP graduates, greater responsibility in administering the program. This was when Sonya Hintz, first briefly as a member and then chair of the Executive Committee, began almost two decades of being to many the face of the PPP, giving it a continuity of presence and leadership. As Davis Suskind, who was there at the beginning, said, “Because of Sonya’s stabilizing force, sensitivity, and her educational commitment, the PPP has increasingly become an integral and important part of our Institute”.

The final step in integrating the PPP into the SDPC occurred in 2018 when Mojgan Khademi, as director of education at the time, combined the first years of the PPP with the first two years of the Analytic Training Program. Fittingly, Sonya became part of the working group that designed the combined program and its curriculum.

Esther Globe — Our Silent Angel and Our New Home: 1994

By 1990, the San Diego Psychoanalytic Society and Institute was facing a crisis of rising rents and shrinking income. This led to Nadine Levinson being appointed to chair an endowment fund committee. She soon recommended to the board that it would be to our financial advantage to own our own building, which would require raising money from our membership for a down payment. After a series of members meetings led by Nadine, the board and membership voted to approve this, and Nadine was appointed chair of a building search committee. Over the next two years close to \$225,000 was raised through the generous donations of our members. However, this was only about half of what was needed for a down payment on a building of the size we needed.

Then on June 14, 1993, an unexpected letter from a local bank was received in the SDPSI rented offices by our administrator, Joyce Harding, informing us that we had been named to receive a bequest of \$230,000 from the estate of Esther Globe, who had passed away on April 28, 1993 after a long illness.

As Haig Koshkarian, President of SDPSI at the time, reported to the membership, Esther was a psychoanalytically-oriented social worker by virtue of the psychoanalytic treatment and supervision she received in New York before coming to San Diego. Here, while working at the South Bay Guidance Clinic, she did evaluations for us as part of our low fee clinic beginning in the late 1960s and extending to 1977. Some of our members, like Eli Miller, had gotten to know her at that time. But we had had no contact with her for the past 15 years. She was a self-effacing woman, and characteristically, she gave us no notice of her incredible gift so that we could have thanked and honored her during her lifetime. Her gift to us was born of deep gratitude for the role psychoanalysis played in her life and her feelings about the importance of the place of psychoanalysis in the community. Haig ended by saying it was humbling to be the beneficiary of such gratitude and generosity. Her bequest, when added to the donations of our membership, made it possible for us to make a substantial down payment on our new home, a building on La Jolla Blvd. which we moved into in March, 1994. It was paid off in 1999.

We happily remained there until 2006 when, because of the wish for a larger space and more accessible parking, we began looking for a larger space. Again, Nadine took the lead, both in selling our building and, after an extensive search, purchasing our current space on Morena Boulevard, which we have been happy with. At the same time, many members still have fond memories of that quirky little building in Bird Rock in La Jolla.

Alan Sugarman: Long Distance Runner

In 2004, at a dinner SDPSI held to thank and honor Alan (our second power weightlifter, that's right) for his just-completed two terms as director of education, Haig Koshkarian, who was MCing

the evening, referred to Alan as a “long-distance runner”. Already a training and supervising analyst in child, adolescent, and adult psychoanalysis, Haig was referring to Alan’s year-after-year giving of extraordinary amounts of time supervising and teaching, as well as holding multiple administrative and committee positions. Little did we know back then that Alan was just warming up. Just getting started.

He was already a prolific writer in 2004. But in the years since, his published writings came to number over 120, all of them in some way applying developmental thinking to issues of technique and psychopathology. In the process, Alan helped shape how psychoanalysis is taught and practiced both locally and nationally. In addition, if anything, he doubled the time he gave to teaching courses, as well as supervising and mentoring students and younger psychoanalysts.

This led in 2013 to Alan’s taking the lead in the Education Committee to soften what he and others felt were redundant and excessive requirements for progression and graduation from the Analytic Training Program. The results were immediate. In June 2013 we had 11 graduates, the largest analytic graduating class in our history. It also had a positive impact on the recruitment of new students.

Alan’s interests also came to include psychoanalytic issues at the national level. He held a number of positions at the American Psychoanalytic Association before being asked in 2016 to be the first head of the Department of Psychoanalytic Education, a position he held until 2020.

DPE, as it was referred to, replaced BOPS (the Board on Professional Standards) which throughout its long history periodically descended upon member institutes for mandatory site visits. During which they would sit in on Education Committee and Board meetings, as well as classes and supervisory sessions. All of it was intended to evaluate and enforce strict national standards at member institutes on what was being taught and how well it was being taught.

They were not pleasant affairs. In fact, they were dreaded. Even though everyone involved, including those being evaluated, put on a friendly face, with even some wining and dining. And then waited for the verdict from the American after the site visit team had left.

Alan had been one of those at the national level who was against this policing model of the Board on Professional Standards and wished to replace it with a more friendly, supportive, consultative model. And this he was able to do in his role as the first head of the Department of Psychoanalytic Education, whose charge it was to be a supportive committee that was available to offer consultation and feedback to member institutes that requested it.

Lee Jaffe: Visionary — We Become the San Diego Psychoanalytic Center

It has been said that Lee Jaffe never met an organization that he did not think needed restructuring. This was the case in high school, college, and graduate school in organizations in which he held leadership positions. It also showed itself in his childhood when he loved to take apart and put back together things in his mother's kitchen cabinet and his father's workshop. This is all true. He usually ended up with a few extra pieces that did not fit anywhere. This pleased him as it made him feel he had created something new. His parents were not so pleased.

When Lee came to San Diego for psychoanalytic training, he quickly became part of the life and work of the SDPSI. Not surprisingly, as a candidate he became the president of the Candidates Association. And then in 2009, he was elected president and chair of the board and served two terms ending in 2013. He immediately began to make, with the concurrence of the Board, structural changes in committees and their functions. But then his thoughts went to bigger things, a larger vision of what SDPSI could and should become. This became his greatest accomplishment as well as his legacy, and it changed the trajectory of the San Diego psychoanalytic community.

His idea was to change our name from the San Diego Psychoanalytic Society and Institute to the San Diego Psychoanalytic Center in order to denote a more welcoming, open, and inclusive place. Some members were reluctant to give up the historical and traditional terms Society and Institute. While recognizing and respecting the historical importance of these terms, Lee felt they placed the entire focus on our training programs and left out our Extension Division continuing education presentations which were not just for our members, but also other mental health professionals in the community.

He suggested that Psychoanalytic Center denoted a place where a lot of psychoanalytic things were happening, aimed at attracting a mental health and lay community interested in psychoanalytic ideas in addition to our training programs. And most important, the idea was not just to create the image of a more welcoming and inclusive place, but to actually become more of one. After much discussion and debate, Lee's proposal that we become the San Diego Psychoanalytic Center was overwhelmingly approved in 2014, denoting a collective commitment to a community-oriented identity.

Then in 2016, Lee was elected President of the American Psychoanalytic Association, the first member of the San Diego psychoanalytic community to be elected to that position. He served as president-elect from 2016 to 2018 and then president from 2018 to 2020. Not surprisingly, he was pivotal in making a number of needed organizational changes. Sadly, he had to leave his position early in February 2020 because of a neurological illness and tragically died in June 2020.

Lee lived long enough to see his vision for the San Diego Psychoanalytic Center to become a more welcoming place begin to become reality with an increase in events of interest to the community. But he did not live long enough to see his dream continue to grow with the combined

work of current leaders, President Tim Rayner, Directors of Education Laurie Weiss and Mojgan Khademi, and Chair of the Professional Development Committee (formerly Extension Division) Mariela Shibley working closely with our most talented administrator, Jody Neels, leading to a literal mushrooming of seminars, events, talks, and courses for our members, other mental health professionals, and the lay community. A truly welcoming psychoanalytic happening place.

Today and the Future

Today, the San Diego Psychoanalytic Center continues to thrive as a volunteer-driven organization. We are made up of a remarkable and dedicated mix and community of mental health professionals, all of whom literally give hundreds of hours year after year to the life and work of SDPC. Except for our administrator, we are a totally volunteer organization that depends on our members to fill all teaching, leadership, and committee positions, while at the same time paying yearly membership dues. That we do this reflects a dedication to carrying on the tradition, soul, and place of psychoanalytic thinking and education. And that we feel we receive much in return collegially, educationally, and in a sense of community.

We are held together by a shared sense of purpose, as well as a shared sense of humor. Our history is filled with satirical radio shows by the SDPC Players demonstrating our ability to laugh at ourselves, and formal dinners where outgoing officers are honored while being roasted with affectionate irreverence. All of this ensuring that while we take our mission seriously, we never take ourselves too seriously.

“We are held together by a shared sense of purpose, as well as a shared sense of humor... ensuring that while we take our mission seriously, we never take ourselves too seriously.”
